

Never buy from sites which you don't trust. Before giving out your password, check if the site is genuine. This way, you can ensure that you are on a site that is secure and respects your patronage.

While making online transactions, ensure that you are on a secure connection. Always check for the <https://> link and the symbol of the lock. If you don't find it, look out for other places to shop from, preferably one that allows for a secure transaction.

Online shopping should mostly be done on a personal computer. Public computers are meant for use by many members and this is not exactly the right place to share your credit information. These public systems save usernames, passwords and even cookies, making it easier to access information. So, use your personal computer.

Your password should be a high security one where you get alerts each time you make an online transaction. This is highly recommended for those who use a debit card. Most banks offer this service automatically but if yours doesn't, sign up for it right away. You can also opt for a 3D secure code which will offer additional protection. This is very helpful if you are a regular online shopper.

Use virtual keyboard to key in your important details. Most physical keyboards can be broken with key logger software. But the virtual keyboard is highly secure and safe from such attacks.

Use a VCC or a virtual credit card. This is handy as you can shop online without sharing much of your credit card information on the merchant website. This is a one-time usable credit card with a limited balance. This feature is usually available with your netbanking option. And ensure that you don't buy a VCC from any online dealer. When in doubt, approach your bank.

Finally, keep a track of your transactions as well as your account statement, which will show where you have purchased and when. In case of any unrecognised transaction, inform your bank immediately and lodge a complaint.

Beat that bully

The cyber bully is on the rise. Any type of bullying falls under the dominion of unpleasant and the cyber forum doesn't make it any different. Cyber bullying includes stalking, sending messages of a threatening nature, altering images and distributing them on the internet with the intentions of harassing or intimidating people.